

1. Voice and Accountability (VA)

Voice and Accountability (VA) captures perceptions of the extent to which citizens can participate in selecting their government including electoral integrity, and of accountability mechanisms for citizens—reflected in the ability to access information, governmental oversight bodies, and a robust traditional/digital media landscape.

The table below lists the individual indicators drawn from each underlying data source and incorporated into the revised WGI. These indicators represent the specific questions or variables used to estimate the VA governance scores for the most recent year available. In some cases, question wording differs in earlier years, and three data sources have been discontinued (but continue to be used in the calculation of governance measures for the past years in which they were available). Users should consult the WGI website for a [complete list](#) of source-specific data files containing all historical indicators.

Before the data are used in the aggregation model, each question or variable is rescaled to range from 0 to 1, with higher values corresponding to better governance outcomes. When a data source includes multiple questions or variables related to the same dimension, the rescaled values are averaged to produce a single source–dimension input prior to aggregation. This ensures that each source contributes only one signal per dimension and prevents data providers with more questions from being given undue weight.

Representative Sources

Code	Question or Variable
EIU	Accountability of public officials Democracy Index Human rights
FRH	Civil Liberties - Freedom of Expression and Belief (FRW) Civil Liberties - Personal Autonomy and Individual Rights (FRW) Electoral Process (NIT) Freedom of the Net (FOTN) Independent Media (NIT) Political Rights (FRW)
GWP	WP144 Confidence in honesty of elections (%YES)
OBI	International Budget Project Open Budget Index (OBI)
PRS	Democratic accountability Military in Politics
RSF	Reporters without Borders
VDM	Clean Elections - Election Management Body (EMB) capacity (v2elembcap) Clean Elections - Election Management Body (EMB) autonomy (v2elembaut) Clean Elections - Election free and fair (v2elfrfair) Clean Elections - Election government intimidation (v2elintim) Clean Elections - Election other electoral violence (v2elpeace) Clean Elections - Election other voting irregularities (v2elirreg) Clean Elections - Election vote buying (v2elvotbuy)

Code	Question or Variable
	Clean Elections - Election voter registry (v2elrgstry)
	Expanded Freedom of Expression (v2x_freexp_altinf)
WJP	Factor 1: Constraints on Government Powers
	Factor 3: Open Government
	Factor 4: Fundamental Rights

Non-representative Sources

Code	Question or Variable
ADB	Transparency, Accountability & Corruption in the Public Sector
AFR	Freedom and fairness of the last national election
	Trust parliament/national assembly
ARB	How much trust you have in the elected council of representatives (the parliament)?
	In your opinion, do the following occur during the elections in your country? Voters are bribed
	In your opinion, do the following occur during the elections in your country? Voters are offered a genuine choice in elections
	In your opinion, do the following occur during the elections in your country? Votes are counted fairly
ASB	Quality of Governance: All citizens from different ethnic communities in your country are treated equally by the government
	Quality of Governance: Between elections, the people have no way of holding the government responsible for its actions
	Quality of Governance: Citizens are able to remove a government they don't like through elections
	Quality of Governance: How often do government officials withhold important information from the public?
	Quality of Governance: How often do you think our elections offer the voters a real choice between different parties/candidates?
	Quality of Governance: In our country, parties and candidates not in power have opportunities to be elected into government
	Quality of Governance: People are free to speak what they think without fear
	Quality of Governance: To what extent is the legislature capable of keeping government leaders in check?
	Trust in Institutions: Parliament
ASD	Transparency, Accountability & Corruption in the Public Sector
BTI	Political Participation
	Stability of Democratic Institutions – Performance of Democratic Institutions
CCR	Accountability and Public Voice
	Civil Liberties
EQI	Confidence in Parliament
	Elections are Not Free and Fair
EUB	Trust in the National Parliament
GII	In practice, appointments the agency/agencies mandated to organize and monitor national elections support the independence of the agency/agencies.
	In practice, appointments to the national cabinet take gender into consideration.
	In practice, candidates/political parties have equitable access to state-owned media outlets.
	In practice, citizen requests for public information are effective.
	In practice, citizens can access legislative processes and documents.

Code	Question or Variable
	In practice, citizens can access the financial records associated with natural resources exploitation (gas, oil and mining), whether they involve the participation of public or private corporations.
	In practice, citizens can access the financial records of state-owned companies.
	In practice, citizens can access the results and documents associated with procurement contracts (full contract, proposals, execution reports, financial audits, etc.).
	In practice, journalists and editors adhere to strict, professional practices in their reporting.
	In practice, media organizations (print, broadcast, online) disclose the identities of their owners to the public.
	In practice, political parties regularly disclose private donations and the disclosures are easily available to the public.
	In practice, political parties regularly disclose public donations (funds that are sourced from the government) and the disclosures are easily available to the public.
	In practice, the agency/agencies mandated to organize and monitor national elections make/s timely, publicly available reports before and after a national election.
	In practice, the asset disclosure process for members of the civil service is effective.
	In practice, the asset disclosure process for senior officials of the three branches of government (heads of state and government, ministers, members of Parliament, judges, etc.) is effective.
	In practice, the government protects LGBT citizens from discrimination based on sexual orientation.
	In practice, the government protects citizens from discrimination based on religious beliefs.
	In practice, the government protects ethnic minorities from discrimination.
	In practice, there is no prior government restraint (pre-publication censoring) and the government doesn't promote the media's self-censorship.
	In practice, there is no prior government restraint (pre-publication censoring) of citizen-created content online and the government doesn't promote the self-censorship of citizens online (in blogs, social media, etc.).
	In practice, women are significantly represented in the highest branch of the judiciary (Constitutional Court/Supreme Court).
	In practice, women are significantly represented in the legislature.
HRM	Right to Opinion and Expression
	Right to Participate in Government
IRP	Boycotts by Opposition Parties
	Election Day Procedures
	Electoral Violence
	Freedom of Assembly and Speech
	Freedom of Voter Choice
	Losers' Acceptance of Results
	Opposition Parties Allowed
	Pre-election Procedures
	Turnover of Executive Power
LBO	Trust in Parliament
MSI	Principle 2: Multiple Channels: How Information Flows
PIA	Transparency, Accountability and Corruption in the Public Sector
VAB	Trust in Congress
WCY	Transparency of government policy is satisfactory

Code	Organization	Data Source
ADB	African Development Bank	Country Policy and Institutional Assessment
AFR	Afrobarometer	Afrobarometer Surveys
ARB	Arab Barometer	Arab Barometer Surveys
ASB	Asian Barometer	Asian Barometer Survey
ASD	Asian Development Bank	Country Performance Assessment
BPS	World Bank; European Bank for Reconstruction and Development	Business Environment and Enterprise Performance Survey (BEEPS)
BTI	Bertelsmann Foundation	Bertelsmann Transformation Index
CCR	Freedom House	Countries at the Crossroads
EBR	European Bank for Reconstruction and Development	Transition Indicators
EIU	Economist Intelligence Unit	Operational Risk Service; Democracy Index
EQI	Quality of Governance Institute at University of Gothenburg	European Quality of Governance Index
EUB	European Union	Eurobarometer
FRH	Freedom House	Freedom in the World; Freedom of the Net; Nations in Transit
GCB	Transparency International	Global Corruption Barometer
GCS	World Economic Forum	Executive Opinion Survey
GII	African Institute for Development Policy	Africa Integrity Indicators
GWP	Gallup	Gallup World Poll
HER	Heritage Foundation	Index of Economic Freedom
HRM	Human Rights Measurement Initiative	Rights Tracker
HUM	University of North Carolina-Asheville	Political Terror Scale
IFD	International Fund for Agricultural Development	Rural Sector Performance Assessment
IJT	Crisis24	Country Security Assessment Ratings
IRP	Ghana Center for Democratic Development	African Electoral Integrity Index
LBO	Latinobarometro	Latinobarometro
MSI	International Research and Exchanges Board	Vibrant Information Barometer
OBI	International Budget Partnership	Open Budget Survey
PIA	World Bank	Country Policy and Institutional Assessment
PRS	The PRS Group	International Country Risk Guide
RSF	Reporters Without Borders	Press Freedom Index
VAB	Center for Global Democracy at Vanderbilt University	Americas Barometer Survey
VDM	Varieties of Democracy Institute	Varieties of Democracy
WBS	World Bank	Enterprise Surveys
WCY	Institute for Management Development (IMD)	World Competitiveness Report Survey
WJP	World Justice Project	Rule of Law Index
WMO	S&P Global	Country Risk Scores